Chapter 1: The most important idea of my life

Why does the most powerful technology of our time bear the seal of a Caribbean paradise and how was the idea of creating the .ia Denomination of Origin born?

First and most important: welcome. I hope you find this story enjoyable and fun.

Where do I start? To introduce myself: my name is Eloy López, I am 47 years old, I have lived in Alcorcón for twenty years, but I come from Tarragona. I work as a computer scientist and programmer, and I am a disastrous father. I have the pathetic ability of not being good at almost anything. Well, I lie: there is something I am good at, thinking. I can spend hours thinking about my moves. Since I was little I have always had the feeling that I thought more than the rest. This doesn't mean I'm smarter; On the contrary, I have always thought that in terms of intelligence I was one step behind average, but, thanks to that extra ability to think things through, I was capable of solving any problem that crossed my path.

And that's what this story is about: an idea that occurred to me that has the potential to change the future of civilization as we know it. And I'm not exaggerating.

What is that idea? The year was 2019 and I was surfing on the internet. At that time, artificial intelligence was already hitting hard and some companies were beginning to adopt the .ai domain, which caught my attention. I thought: if there is an English version, surely in Spanish I can register a domain with great potential. But no: the domain .ia does not exist. A pity. To register a ccTLD there was only one way (at least that I knew of at the time): it had to be associated with an independent geographical territory. For example, Isle of Man corresponds to .im. Because of that rule of three, I started looking for islands. At first I looked for Spanish islands that began with "A", but at one point Antikythera occurred to me and something "clicked" in my head. It was an absolute crush: the more I analyzed it, the more perfect the idea became. The ingenuity of our ancestors, the first analog computer in history, was the perfect symbol for modern artificial intelligence. But well, this was still a nice chimera in my head. Impossible, you say? "Hold my cubata"... and thus began the Odyssey of the .ia.

The birth of the idea

A new idea was born. At first I didn't really know what to do with it; I didn't even dare to tell anyone around me. But in my head it didn't stop growing, it occupied a large part of my thoughts. I spent hours and hours thinking about it, researching, looking for information, comparing data, analyzing possibilities, weighing risks, calculating benefits. And the more I did it, the more I became convinced that it was something big, something important, something that could change the world. But I was also aware that it was something very difficult, very complicated, something that required a lot of time, a lot of effort and a lot of money. So I put it in a drawer, let it sit, let it mature. But I didn't forget it. I couldn't forget it. It was like a thorn in my heart, a thorn that kept me from sleeping at night and prevented me from enjoying the simple things in life.

It was in 2019 when, upon reading the article "Artificial Intelligence in Spanish" by José María Álvarez-Pallete, then president of Telefónica, I realized that I could take advantage of the opportunity to leave my comment on the article to tell my idea to everyone. world. I was the first comment and for some time it was the only one. Then a few more appeared, but none of the comments contributed anything new to the idea: they were just unnecessary noise. The funny thing is that they disappeared over time and currently only mine can be read.

I recently had the great satisfaction of contacting José María Álvarez-Pallete through MyPublicInbox and telling him that his article was the spark that lit the fuse of my idea. This was his response:

> Dear Eloy: > > Thank you very much for your message and for what you detail in it. That that ABC article has given rise to an initiative like yours makes me very happy and I sincerely thank you for writing to tell me about it. I also take this opportunity to congratulate you on this, because I find it especially necessary in these times. > > Best regards, > José M.ª